
1 Introduction to Transaction Management

A **transaction** is a logical unit of work that consists of one or more database operations. Transaction Management ensures that these operations are executed **reliably and consistently**.

A transaction must follow **ACID properties**:

- **A – Atomicity**: All operations succeed or all fail
- **C – Consistency**: Database remains in a valid state
- **I – Isolation**: Transactions do not interfere with each other
- **D – Durability**: Committed data is permanent

ACID Properties – Real-Time Explanation

A – Atomicity (All or Nothing)

Definition:

A transaction must either **complete fully** or **not execute at all**.

Real-Time Example (ATM Transaction):

- ₹10,000 is debited from Account A
- ₹10,000 is credited to Account B

If credit fails due to network issue:

Debit must be **rolled back**

Ensures no partial updates

C – Consistency (Valid State)

Definition:

A transaction must take the database from **one valid state to another**.

Real-Time Example (Banking Rule):

- Account balance cannot be negative
- Total money before = total money after transfer

If a rule is violated:

Transaction is **rolled back**

Business rules & constraints are always maintained

I – Isolation (No Interference)

Definition:

Multiple transactions executing at the same time **should not affect each other**.

Real-Time Example (Online Ticket Booking):

- Two users try to book the **same seat**
- Only one booking succeeds
- Other transaction waits or fails

Prevents dirty reads, lost updates

D – Durability (Permanent Data)

Definition:

Once a transaction is committed, data **will not be lost**, even after failures.

Real-Time Example (Power Failure):

- Money transfer is successful
- System crashes immediately after
- Data remains saved in database

Ensured using logs, backups, and disk storage

2 Local Transaction vs Distributed Transaction

Local Transaction

A **local transaction** involves **only one resource**, usually a **single database**.

Characteristics:

- Uses a single DataSource
- Managed by JDBC or ORM (Hibernate)
- Simple and fast
- Limited to one database

Example:

```
Connection con = dataSource.getConnection();  
con.setAutoCommit(false);
```

Use Case:

- One application
 - One database
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Distributed Transaction

A **distributed transaction** involves **multiple resources**, such as:

- Multiple databases
- Database + JMS
- Multiple microservices

Characteristics:

- Managed using **XA protocol**
- Uses **Two-Phase Commit (2PC)**
- Complex and slower
- Requires transaction manager (JTA)

Example:

DB1 → Update
DB2 → Update
Message Queue → Send

Use Case:

- Enterprise applications
- Banking systems
- Microservices architecture

Comparison Table

Feature	Local Transaction	Distributed Transaction
Resources	Single	Multiple
Complexity	Low	High
Performance	Faster	Slower
Manager	JDBC / ORM	JTA / XA
Rollback scope	One DB	Multiple systems

3 Need of Spring Transaction Management

Spring provides a **consistent, simple, and powerful** way to manage transactions.

Problems without Spring

- Manual transaction handling
- Boilerplate code
- Tight coupling to APIs
- Error-prone rollback logic

Example (without Spring):

```
try {  
    con.setAutoCommit(false);  
    // business logic  
    con.commit();  
} catch (Exception e) {  
    con.rollback();  
}
```

Advantages of Spring Transaction Management

. Declarative Transaction Management

Use annotations instead of code:

```
@Transactional
public void transferMoney() {
    debit();
    credit();
}
```

2. Consistent Abstraction

Spring hides underlying APIs:

- JDBC
- Hibernate
- JPA
- JTA

You write **one style of code**.

3. Automatic Rollback

- Rolls back on runtime exceptions
 - Configurable rollback rules
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4. Supports Both Local & Distributed Transactions

- DataSourceTransactionManager → Local
 - JtaTransactionManager → Distributed
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5. Separation of Concerns

- Business logic is clean
 - Transaction logic is externalized
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4.Conclusion

Spring Transaction Management:

- Simplifies transaction handling
- Reduces boilerplate code
- Improves reliability
- Supports enterprise-level applications

That's why Spring Transaction Management is essential in real-world applications.